



Above: Wow! The Ambanis really use stupid passwords for their Net Banking accounts

Below: An 11 year old disarms a nuclear bomb with 1 second to spare!



logged on to a bank's Web site, and is looking for the password to one of the Ambanis' accounts. His 'program' is a little genie that appears on the Web page and scrapes off data from the site while looking for a password. In the end, the password he finds is 'gudiya'. If Milind Soman hadn't stopped him, he would have stolen crores from the Ambanis, using the username 'Ambani' and the password 'gudiya'.



How Jeff Goldblum manages to interface with an alien system and create a virus to crash it is beyond us

Jeff Goldblum's character manages to do this in a matter of hours!

Let's not even begin to talk about an alien race that traverses the universe to go to war with us, runs everything on computers, and does not believe in anti-virus software to protect against viruses created by those much lower down in the technology chain!

We're Not Stupid

There are perhaps thousands of movies out there that have loads of technology goof-ups, but it's good to see the effort



So basically the movie expects you to believe that one of the Ambanis has Rs 70 crore in his personal savings account, which is accessible via the Internet, and is protected with only the password 'gudiya'. Yawn!

So we sat through the rest of this movie, looking for more mistakes. We got tired of counting. Someone tell Bollywood makers that we still do not have 3D-holographic displays! And even if there are any, no 10-year-old would be allowed to touch them!

At the end, there's a scene where the same child prodigy is copy-pasting wave graphs so he can match the villain's voice and disable the nuclear bomb that's about to blow Delhi to smithereens. The computer screen clearly shows a mouse action of dragging and dropping, yet all this kid is doing is rattling away at his keyboard. The funniest part is when he finally gets the specific word phrase he is looking for he does nothing, until our hero Milind Soman helpfully reminds him to press [Enter]!

If Hollywood has a long way to go before making truly immersive movies, let's not even imagine how much help Bollywood is going to need. With all the computer whizzes we have walking about our streets, it's shameful to see directors not consulting with them to understand the limits to which they can stretch our imaginations—at least in terms of technology. The least they could do is pick up a copy of *Digit* every now and then!

that movie makers are putting in to improve the believability of their stories. As technology invades more and more people's lives, perhaps soon we'll see movies that don't divert our minds from plots by making silly mistakes. After all, in all the movies mentioned here (with the exception of *Hackers* and *The Net*, perhaps) technology was just a prop, but ended up taking centre stage because of glaring errors.

It's time that the Holly- and Bollywoods of the world start accepting that we, their audience, are not stupid any more, and will not just sit down and believe or accept anything they throw at us.

Some people might argue that movies are meant to be journeys of fantasy, and need not conform to real-world boundaries. However, to be truly immersive, movies need to be based firmly on reality. This is the reason why horror movies may not scare us, but walking down a dark, desolate street in the middle of the night makes us edgy!

We'd love to hear your take on this subject, and also hear about more technology goofs you might have seen! Write in to us. ■

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